Prodigy Anesthesia Quick Review

Tonsillectomy/Adenoidectomy

Why should nasal airways be avoided during the induction of patients presenting for adenoidectomy if mask ventilation proves difficult?	Nasal airways can result in bleeding due to trauma caused to the hypertrophied adenoid tissue. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 209.*
Name two patient populations in which premedication should be avoided prior to a tonsillectomy?	Patients with OSA, patients with symptoms of upper airway obstruction. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 209.*
An adult patient arrives for a tonsillectomy/adenoidectomy with fever, nasal secretions, and purulent sputum. Should the patient continue with the planned procedure?	No. The patient is exhibiting signs of an acute URI. General guidelines advise for the postponement of any elective procedure until symptoms subside. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 209.*
Once the mouth gag is applied, why is it imperative to verify the position of the ETT?	The mouth gag can dislodge, kink, or obstruct the ETT, as evidenced by a change in chest movement, breath sounds, and PIP. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 210.*
Following a tonsillectomy, what would alert you to the possibility of an ongoing bleed?	Frequent swallowing *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 211.*
What type of extubation ensures the maximum protection of an airway?	An awake extubation *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 208.*
Why should hypercapnia be avoided during emergence in a patient who has undergone tonsillectomy/adenoidectomy?	Hypercapnia casues vasodilation which can cause an increase in bleeding. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 208.*

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How is the patient positioned postoperatively following a tonsillectomy?	The patient should be placed in the lateral position with the head facing downward. This is known as the "tonsillar position". *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 210.*
Where is the ETT secured in a patient undergoing tonsillectomy?	The ETT is placed midline and secured to the lower lip. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 208.*
What are common preoperative diagnoses in patients presenting for tonsillectomy and/or adenoidectomy?	The most common diagnosis is chronic tonsillitis with or without adenoiditis. Other diagnoses include: OSA, snoring, peritonsillar abscess, nasal airway obstruction, and asymmetric enlargement of tonsils (this is done to rule out cancer). *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 207.*
How is a patient positioned for a tonsillectomy?	The patient is positioned supine with the shoulders elevated. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 208.*
Should a pediatric patient presenting for tonsillectomy with nasal congestion without fever proceed with surgery or have the surgery postponed?	The surgery can proceed as scheduled. Patients that have fever with a productive cough and wheezing display symptoms involving the lower respiratory tract and should be rescheduled. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 1211.*
What impact can severe adenoidal hyperplasia have on the pediatric patient?	Sleep and speech disturbances, obligate mouth breathing, nasopharyngeal obstruction, and failure to thrive due to poor feeding can be seen in this patient population. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 1213.*
What are some possible postoperative complications following a tonsillectomy/adenoidectomy?	Laryngospasm, bleeding, retained throat pack (causing upper airway obstruction), postobstructive pulmonary edema *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 211.*

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